



Ethics Commission Meeting July 9th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1FtwbnG5LbY
Publication Date	2025-07-09T22:21:13Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Report: Muncie Ethics Commission

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the regular July meeting of the Muncie Ethics Commission to order, welcoming newly appointed member Frank Scott II. The chair also noted structural updates to the meeting agenda and notices to comply with new statutory requirements effective July 1 that mandate meeting streaming and archiving information.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Chip Taylor (Chair), Susan Dylan, Sandra Whitaker, Jim Low, and Frank Scott II.
 - **Absent:** None. (All present).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Chip Taylor.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Welcoming remarks extended to new commissioner Frank Scott II.
- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - **Action:** Approved the minutes from the previous June meeting as submitted.
 - **Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:02:00 Initial Action on Ethics Complaint: EC25-14**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commission Chair / Board Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The chair noted that the complaint was filed with the Muncie city clerk on June 16, 2025, and forwarded to the Ethics Commission. The commission previously met in executive session on June 25, 2025, pursuant to Section 42.01C of the City of Muncie Code of Ordinances. Operating under Section 42.01D, the board considered formal action. A motion was made to stay proceedings because additional investigation is deemed necessary based on executive session reviews.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None permitted at this stage per commission rules and ordinances.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to stay proceedings to conduct further investigation passed via roll-call vote (Chip Taylor: Yes; Susan Dylan: Yes; Sandra Whitaker: Yes; Frank Scott II: Yes; Jim Low: Yes).
 - **00:04:52 Appointment of Investigating Committee & Scope Authorization**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chip Taylor, Chair.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Pursuant to commission rules, the chair appointed Sandra Whitaker and himself (Chip Taylor) to serve as the investigating committee for complaint EC25-14. The board then reviewed and considered a detailed scope of investigation authorizing the committee to interview the complainant, potential witnesses, and the respondent, as well as to verify evidentiary documents. The scope also authorizes the committee to in consultation with legal counsel to compel the production of documents/evidence (Section 41.047) and attendance/testimony of witnesses via subpoenas (Section 41.048) if deemed necessary, though subpoenas are not currently anticipated.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion regarding the scope of the investigation passed via roll-call vote (Chip Taylor: Yes; Susan Dylan: Yes; Sandra Whitaker: Yes; Frank Scott II: Yes; Jim Low: Yes).
 - **00:09:32 Old Business: Electronic Meeting Policy**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commission Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board revisited the electronic meeting policy previously discussed in June. With no suggested changes or amendments, a motion was brought forward to adopt the policy as written.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to adopt the electronic meeting policy passed via roll-call vote (Chip Taylor: Yes; Susan Dylan: Yes; Sandra Whitaker: Yes; Frank Scott II: Yes; Jim Low: Yes).
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *Note:* No general open public comment period or citizen forum was conducted during this meeting.
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements (00:10:36):**
 - **Transparency Portal Update:** Chair reported collaboration with Belinda Mson, Lacy Jones, and the city clerk's office to set up the commission's new transparency portal on the city's website in compliance with code requirements. The portal features eight organized folders covering: (1) ethics code and procedures, (2) member history and term limits, (3) state conflict of interest forms, (4) advisory opinions, (5) public complaint documents and dismissal forms, (6) annual reports, (7) compliance training reports and quarterly updates provided by Patty Goddard, state board of account forms, and relative contract disclosures, and (8) public documents related to purchases of \$5,000 or more.
 - **Purchasing Memo:** A memo regarding documentation for purchases over \$5,000 was finalized with Alan Wisley (filling in for Aubrey Christrist) and distributed to official email recipients earlier that morning.
 - **Adjournment (00:17:50):**
 - **Action:** Motion to adjourn the meeting.
 - **Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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